

William Fawson, PhD

Postdoctoral Research Fellow
London Business School
Regent's Park, London, NW1 4SA
wfawson@london.edu

Please feel free to connect with me on [LinkedIn](#). For further information, visit my [Website](#).

Summary

My research examines how people build, maintain, and manage their reputations. In particular, I study how people signal competence and moral character to others.

My research is currently under revise and resubmit at the *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General and Nature Human Behaviour* and has been featured in *Forbes* and *Think*. I was recently awarded Early Career Scholar by the *International Association for Conflict Management*.

At London Business School, I teach Personal Assessment & Development to students in the Masters in Finance program. I am also a guest lecturer in the Power & Influence MBA elective at IESE Business School, where I earned my PhD.

Before entering academia, I spent seven years working in finance and strategy consulting in London and Amsterdam, and two years as a career mentor in Barcelona. I hold a BSc in Economics and Politics from the University of Bath, an MBA from IESE Business School, and I am a Chartered Accountant in the United Kingdom.

Academic Positions

London Business School – London, United Kingdom Postdoctoral Research Fellow (Advisor: Ena Inesi)	2025- Present
---	------------------

Education

IESE Business School – Barcelona, Spain PhD in Management	2021-25
---	---------

- Dissertation: On the Nature, Antecedents and Effects of Status
- Cum Laude (Distinction)
- Advisors: Sebastien Brion, Anneloes Raes
- Committee: Nicholas Hays, Robert Lount, Maya Rossignac-Milon

IESE Business School – Barcelona, Spain Master of Business Administration	2014-16
---	---------

Institute of Chartered Accountants of Scotland – Edinburgh, United Kingdom Chartered Accountant (CA)	2008-11
--	---------

University of Bath – Bath, United Kingdom Bachelor of Science in Economics and Politics	2004-07
---	---------

Manuscripts under Revise and Resubmit

Fawson, W., & Inesi, M. E. Patrolling the Powerful: The Reputational Consequences of Punishing Power-holders

- Currently under revise and resubmit at the *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*
- [Preprint](#)
- Featured in [Forbes](#)
- Featured in London Business School's [Think](#)

Huber, J., Holzknicht, A., Schwaiger, R., Blanco, E., Kirchler, M., et al. (including **Fawson, W.**) Collective Evidence on Behavioral Interventions Targeting Carbon Pricing Support: A Many-Designs Approach with 55 Studies

- Currently under revise and resubmit at *Nature Human Behaviour*

Manuscripts under Review

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. More Than a Consensus? A Social Relations Model Analysis of Status

- Currently under review at the *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*
- [Preprint](#)

Fawson, W., Berman, J. Z., & Inesi, M. E. Right to Brag? The Reputational Consequences of Disclosing Prosocial Behavior

- Currently under review at the *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*
- [Preprint](#)

Working Papers

Fawson, W. Deviating from the Status Consensus Reduces Psychological Safety (one study complete; target journal *TBD*, expected submission during 2027)

Fawson, W., Bechara, J. P., & Hays, N. A. Status Dissonance Leads to Subversive Status Conflict (two studies complete; target journal *TBD*, expected submission during 2027)

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Lount, R. The Motivational Consequences of Status Variance (three studies complete; target journal *TBD*, expected submission during 2026)

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. The Negative Effect of Narcissism on Dyadic Status Exchanges (one study complete; target journal *TBD*, expected submission during 2027)

Invited Research Talks

London Business School – London, United Kingdom	2025
NEOMA Business School – Rouen, France	2023

Chaired Symposia

Fawson, W. (2023). Innovations in Research in Hierarchy. Chaired symposium at the 83rd *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Boston, United States*

Conference Papers and Talks

Fawson, W., & Inesi, M. E. (2026). Patrolling the Powerful: The Reputational Consequences of Punishing Power-holders. Paper to be presented at the 86th *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Philadelphia, United States*

Fawson, W., Berman, J. Z., & Inesi, M. E. Right to Brag? The Reputational Consequences of Disclosing Prosocial Behavior. Paper to be presented at the 86th *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Philadelphia, United States*

Fawson, W., & Brion, S. (2025). Beyond the Individual: Dyadic Drivers of Status. Paper presented at the 85th *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Copenhagen, Denmark*

Fawson, W., & Hays, N. (2025). The Curvilinear Effect of Receiving Status Dissensus on Effort and Performance. In Zhu, G. (Organizer), *A Social Hierarchy Perspective on Navigating Interpersonal Relationships*. Paper presented at the 85th *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Copenhagen, Denmark*

Fawson, W., & Bechara, J. P.* (2025). The Effect of Status Deservedness on Dyadic Status Conflict in Groups. Paper presented at the 20th *Annual Interdisciplinary Network for Group Research Conference, Rotterdam, Netherlands (*presenter)*

Fawson, W., & Inesi, M. E. (2024). Patrolling the Powerful: Power Predicts the Reputational Consequences of Third-Party Punishment. Data Blitz presented at the 37th *Annual Conference of the International Association for Conflict Management, Singapore*

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. (2023). Beyond Consensus: A Dyadic Perspective on Extraversion Congruence and Status Perception in Groups. In Fawson, W. (Organizer), *Innovations in Research on Hierarchy*. Paper presented at the 83rd *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Boston, United States*

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. (2023). Beyond Consensus: A Theory of Dyadic Status Perception. Paper presented at the 18th *Annual Interdisciplinary Network for Group Research Conference, Seattle, United States*

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A. (2023). Beyond Consensus: A Theory of Dyadic Status Perception. Paper presented at the 36th *Annual Conference of the International Association for Conflict Management, Thessaloniki, Greece*

Fawson, W., Brion, S., & Raes, A.* (2023). Beyond Consensus: A Dyadic Perspective on Status Perception in Groups. Paper presented at the 21st *European Association of Work and Organizational Psychology Congress, Katowice, Poland (*presenter)*

Awards

- Early Career Scholar, *International Association for Conflict Management* (2023)
- Nominated: Best Submission, *21st European Association of Work and Organizational Psychology Congress* (2023)

Grants and Fellowships

- IESE Doctoral Grant 2021
- IESE Foundation Fellowship 2019
- IESE MBA Admissions Scholarship 2014

Teaching

- Lecturer, London Business School** – London, United Kingdom 2025-Present
- Personal Assessment & Development (Masters in Finance)
 - 2025-26 Instructor rating: 4.73/5 (based on 62 student surveys)
- Guest Lecturer, IESE Business School** – Barcelona, Spain 2021-Present
- Power & Influence (MBA/EMBA)

Academic Service

- Service to IESE Business School** 2021-23
- Organised and chaired 48 one-hour Brown Bag seminars for speakers from IESE Business School, Bayes Business School, Esade and IE Business School
- Service to the Academy of Management** 2024-Present
- Reviewer for annual conferences
- Service to the International Association for Conflict Management** 2023-Present
- Reviewer for annual conferences
 - Speaker in 2024 Doctoral Student Workshop for the session “Managing the Interview Process”
- Service to the Interdisciplinary Network for Group Research** 2023-Present
- Reviewer for annual conferences

Work Experience

IESE Business School (www.iese.edu) – Barcelona, Spain 2017-19
Associate Director, Career Development Center

- Devoted 300 hours to mentoring MBA students on breaking into consulting
- Built case interview training content, delivered sessions to 150-student consulting club and conducted more than 100 practice interviews
- Brought six new consulting firms to campus
- Increased placements in top-three strategy consultancies from 28 to 46

Monitor Deloitte (www.deloitte.com) – Amsterdam, Netherlands 2015-17
Strategy Consulting Manager (initially MBA Intern)

- Developed growth strategy for a Polish energy provider
- Led commercial activities in two départements at a French energy provider
- Managed recruitment of MBAs for Deloitte's Dutch practice

IHG Hotels & Resorts (www.ihgplc.com) – London, United Kingdom 2012-14
Corporate Finance Manager

- Analysed the company's financial performance and prepared the CFO to discuss results and outlook in Executive Committee meetings each month
- Coordinated the company's annual budget process
- Worked closely with Investor Relations to manage external analyst coverage

EY (www.ey.com) – London, United Kingdom 2008-12
Audit Senior Associate (initially Audit Associate)

- Managed audits for a major UK-based telco
- Supervised IPO on the New York Stock Exchange for a large software provider
- Studied and passed exams to become a Chartered Accountant

Languages

English: Mother Tongue
French, Italian, Spanish: Good

Interests

I enjoy going to the gym, running, and hiking. Once in a while I take on big challenges—including five Barcelona marathons, and cycling the 4,000km perimeter of the Iberian Peninsula.

References

Anneloes Raes
Professor and Head of Department
Managing People in Organizations
IESE Business School
araes@iese.edu

Sebastien Brion
Professor
Managing People in Organizations
IESE Business School
sbrion@iese.edu

Ena Inesi
Professor
Organisational Behaviour
London Business School
einesi@london.edu